Core rules

Fiction first: say what your runner does and what they want to achieve. You only roll when something dangerous or uncertain is at stake.

Action roll

AS MANY D6 AS YOUR ACTION RATING

Roll and count only the **highest** die.

- **6 + 6** **Critical:** success with an extra benefit.
- **6** **Full success.** You get what you wanted.
- **4/5** **Success with a consequence.** It works, but it costs.
- **1-3** **Bad outcome.** No or the wrong success, plus a consequence.

0 dots in the action: roll 2d6 and take the **lower**, no critical.

Position

HOW BAD CAN IT GET?

POSITION	MEANING
Controlled	You have the upper hand. Mild consequences; you can often back off.
Risky	The default. Things can go seriously wrong.
Desperate	You are in deep trouble. Consequences are severe.

The GM states position and effect **before** the roll. You may negotiate or pick another approach.

Effect

HOW MUCH DO YOU ACHIEVE?

EFFECT	CLOCK SEGMENTS
Limited	1 · partial, half a job
Standard	2 · what you would expect
Great	3 · more than expected

More effect from the right gear, surprise, good preparation. Less from superior numbers, armour, level 1 harm. You may trade position for effect: riskier for more impact.

Edge

9 BOXES · YOUR RESERVE

- **Push (2 edge per benefit):** +1d, +1 effect, or act despite level 3 harm.
- **Assist (1 edge):** a teammate gets +1d. Only one assist per roll. You may suffer consequences yourself.
- **Dragon's deal:** instead of pushing, +1d if you accept a catch offered by the GM or anyone at the table. The catch happens whatever the roll.
- **Resistance:** costs edge (see below).

> **Edge full?** You take a **trauma** (Cold, Haunted, Obsessed, Paranoid, Reckless, Soft, Unstable, Vicious) and are out for the rest of the scene. Edge clears.

There is no recovery tonight: edge and harm stay until the run is over.

Resistance roll

SOFTEN A CONSEQUENCE

A consequence hits you? **Resistance always works**: the GM says whether it is reduced or avoided entirely. The roll only sets the price.

- The GM names the matching **attribute** (value on your sheet).
- Cost: **6 minus your highest die** in edge (5 at most).
- Critical: you regain 1 edge.
- Decide first, then roll. One roll per consequence, and not on top of armour.

ATTRIBUTE	AGAINST …
Intuition	deception, surprise
Body	physical strain, injury
Willpower	mental strain, resolve, fear

Teamwork

BETTER TOGETHER

- **Assist:** 1 edge, +1d for someone else.
- **Setup:** your action prepares the next one. Success gives the team +1 effect or a better position.
- **Group action:** one person leads, everyone rolls the same action, the best result counts. The leader pays 1 edge for each 1–3 in the group.
- **Protect:** step in front of a consequence meant for someone else and take it yourself (resistance allowed).

Flashback

PREPARATION AFTER THE FACT

You don't have to plan ahead. Mid-run, explain what you had already done.

EDGE	EXAMPLE
0	ordinary, easy opportunity: you scouted the way to the garage.
1	complex or unlikely: a weapon is already stashed in the penthouse.
2+	elaborate, special opportunities: your name is on the guest list.

Then it works like any action: sometimes an action roll, sometimes a fortune roll, sometimes no roll at all. A flashback isn't time travel and can't undo anything.

Load

CHOOSE BEFORE THE RUN

LOAD	EFFECT
Light 3	faster, inconspicuous, fits the gala. Armoured clothing or one bulky item.
Normal 4–5	looks like trouble. Heavy armour or two bulky items.
Heavy 6	slower, looks like an operative. Up to three bulky items.

You only decide which items you carry when you need them. Tick them off until your load is reached.

Plan & engagement

NO HOUR-LONG PLANNING

Pick a plan and name the detail. The GM rolls the **engagement roll** and cuts straight to the first danger.

PLAN	DETAIL
Assault	point of attack
Deception	method
Social	connection
Stealth	entry point
Supernatural	magical method
Transport	route & means

A bad engagement doesn't mean you planned badly. Only that it starts hot.

Which action?

Actions are things you do, not knowledge skills. Not “I roll Interface” but: what does your character do? That gives the action. Often several fit; your method sets position and effect.

Intuition

RESISTS DECEPTION & SURPRISE

ACTION	IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE
Engineer	rewire the gondola controls, copy the keycard, build a retina duplicate, disarm a safeguard
Interface	loop cameras, edit the guest list, reroute a lift, forge a door log, take over a drone
Stalk	tail Dr. Venn unnoticed, pick up Kade’s trail, aimed shot at a drone’s optics
Survey	predict Kade’s round, spot the corridor sensors, find an escape route, read the crowd

Body

RESISTS INJURY & STRAIN

ACTION	IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE
Fight	overpower a guard, melee a guardian drone, shove a pistol in someone’s face, hold a position
Finesse	lift the keycard from a pocket, steer the gondola in the wind, land a skycab, disarm
Prowl	sneak through the service wing, climb the façade, slip past light barriers, take someone out from ambush
Wreck	force a door, tear up cover, smash a drone, blast a wall

Willpower

RESISTS FEAR, PRESSURE, MAGIC

ACTION	IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE
Command	boss staff around, intimidate a guard, calm panicking guests
Consort	network with collectors, draw Venn into an expert talk, call a contact
Influence	fool the reception, talk Venn into the airlock, soothe a guard
Study	research provenance, analyse blueprints, detect lies, study a spell formula

Assense

AWAKENED ONLY

Perceive astrally: auras, emotions, spirits, barriers, magical objects. Counts towards the 7 action dots. Dangerous spellcasting is usually rolled with Assense. More on the **Magic** sheet.

The right question

1. What do you want to achieve?
2. How exactly do you do it?
3. What is at stake?

The GM names action, position and effect. If the position sounds too bad, change your approach before you roll.

No roll needed

You are professionals. Routine without danger just works: take a drink, look around the salon, use a commlink, call the lift.

Knowledge, not dice

Whether your character knows something depends on their background. Just ask the GM. You roll when you *obtain* knowledge under pressure, for example with Study or Survey.

Gather information

BEFORE THE RUN

One or two pointed questions per person are enough. Good questions: Where is the keycard? How do I get to Dr. Venn? What gear stands out? Is there a second way in? What lies beneath the penthouse?

Combat

No initiative, no rounds, no hit points for enemies. You describe goal and method, roll one action, and enemies act through the consequences. One roll can cover a whole exchange.

How a fight works

1. Say **what you want to achieve**: blind the drone, take the guard down, hold the corridor.
2. Say **how**: weapon, cover, timing, teamwork.
3. The GM names position and effect. Tough enemies get a **clock**.
4. Roll. The roll counts for both sides: **6** you win, **4/5** both have their effect, **1–3** the enemy wins.

Very dangerous enemies act first. Then you must resist before you can act yourself.

Combat actions

ACTION	FOR
Fight	melee, brawling, a gun at speaking distance, holding a position
Stalk	precision shooting from a distance, arranging an ambush
Prowl	attack from hiding
Finesse	disarm, duel, drive a vehicle
Wreck	savage force, destroy cover and doors, sabotage
Command	intimidate, force surrender
Assense	spells under danger (Awakened only)

What changes effect

- **Numbers:** more or bigger enemies = less effect.
- **Armour:** a holdout pistol barely scratches an armoured drone.
- **Potency:** the right weapon, surprise, a weak spot (EMP against drones, shooting out optics) = more effect.
- **Preparation:** setup action or flashback.

Harm

LEVEL 4 = FATAL

LEVEL	EFFECT	EXAMPLE
1 lesser	less effect	scraped, sprained, tired
2 moderate	−1d	deep cut, concussion
3 severe	incapacitated: only with help or pushing	shot in the chest, broken leg, blinded
4	fatal	dead unless you resist

Levels 1 and 2 have two slots each, level 3 one. If a row is full, new harm moves up a level. The penalty applies when the injury fits the action. Short-lived states like dazed or panicked are not harm; they worsen position or effect.

Armour

BOXES ON YOUR SHEET

- **Armor:** mark to reduce or avoid a fitting consequence **instead of** rolling resistance. Needs Armor in your load (2) or Light Armor (1).
- **Heavy:** a second box, heavy armour only (+2 load). Hardly plausible at the gala.
- Each box works once per evening.
- **Special:** only for what your ability allows (Fizz: detection and escape).
- **Troll armor:** Bastion's extra box.

Johnson's conditions

- **No wetwork:** avoidable deaths are explicitly unwanted.
- **Dr. Venn** must not be harmed.
- Injured or dead guests and staff cut the pay.
- Fighting is loud: gunfire and explosions push the alert clock.

Non-lethal in the crew

`Stunbolt · Ravn`

`Stunlock Vial · Fizz`

`Blowgun · Hush`

`Shock gloves · Bastion`

`Manacles · Bastion`

`Bangflash · Pepper Smoke · Tear Gas`

`EMP against drones`

`Red Rock · Chameleon`

Say up front that you go non-lethal. That changes position and effect, not the danger to you.

What you know about security

- **Gala:** discreet security. They want no visible incident in front of the VIPs.
- **Dorian Kade:** head of security, chrome cyberarms, pistol, lightning fast.
- **Vault level:** unstaffed. Sensors, airlocks and autonomous security drones.

Smarter than fighting

Often better: bypass, distract, lock in, deceive or simply be faster. Solving problems without violence keeps the alert clock low and Johnson happy.

Magic

Magic is real but rare. An Awakened runner is not required, but sees things nobody else does. Everything runs through the same action rolls as any other deed.

Who is Awakened?

RUNNER	MAGIC
Ravn · Mage	Awakened (hermetic) + Sorcerer: Assense and spells
Hush · Adept	Way of the Body: mana in their own body, Adept Senses
everyone else	mundane. Cyberware and magic don't mix well.

Assense

ACTION · AWAKENED ONLY

You open your mind to the astral: auras, arcane traces of recent events, spirits, barriers, magical objects.

- Roll Assense like any action. The position is often worse than with Survey, because the astral itself is dangerous.
- Good effect: more detail, clearer answers.

Casting spells

SORCERER

1. Say which spell you cast, on whom, and what it should achieve. You need the link it requires (touch, sight).
2. If casting is dangerous, roll an action, usually **Assense**. The GM names position and effect.
3. Then pay the **cost** (see below).

Spell Focus (meteoric iron ring): spells with exceptional control. **Arcane Reagents:** reduce the edge cost by 1 or boost the spell by one level, crumble after use.

Cost & drain

SPELL POTENTIAL = ASSENSE

SPELL STRENGTH	COST
below your potential	1 edge *or* level 1 drain (then no resisting)
equal to your potential	1 edge *and* level 1 drain
above it	1 edge *and* level 2 drain

Drain is special harm and a supernatural consequence: you may resist it. Ravn has Assense 1, so potential 1. The GM judges how strong a spell is.

Concentration

Some spells only last while you concentrate (Veil). When your concentration is challenged, re-roll Assense (risking drain) or drop the spell: when you cast another spell, the target takes harm, magic acts against you, or the target is driven to desperation.

Ravn's spells

SPELL	EFFECT
Stunbolt	mental spell: unconsciousness instead of wounds. Non-lethal, silent, visible only to the Awakened. Line of sight.
Veil	an illusion over a person or thing. Lasts while you concentrate. Fools people, **not cameras**.

Adept

HUSH

- **Adept Senses (1 edge):** superhuman perception for minutes: temperature, frequency, pressure, danger, lies.
- You may resist supernatural consequences with **Body**.
- Your aura shines in the astral as brightly as a mage's.

Dangers of magic

Magic can go wrong like anything else. Besides drain:

- Harm from astral backlash (burns, shock).
- The spell works weaker, too strong, or on the wrong thing.
- Astral activity **gets noticed**.

Resisting the supernatural: **Ravn** as a hermetic with Intuition, **Hush** with Body, otherwise by the kind of consequence.

Magic leaves traces

Every spell bears your astral signature, where it was cast and on its target. It fades within minutes but can be tracked until then. If you want to stay quiet, cast deliberately rather than constantly.

Mundane answers

No Awakened in the crew? Flashbacks, Study with knowledge from the net, or gear like Kessel's Search Protocol make up a lot. No obstacle in the tower strictly requires magic.

Matrix, tech & alert

The Meridian Spire is full of networked tech. Hackers get many chances to shine, but no exclusive right. And building security remembers what you do.

The alert clock

6 SEGMENTS · VISIBLE

0–1 Routine Anomalies count as normal event deviations.

2–3 Suspicion Cameras cross-check, doors ask again, staff get questioned.

4–5 Alarm Drones search, lifts stop, identified runners are tracked.

6 Lockdown Exits sealed, external response called. Escalation, not game over.

What drives alert

- cameras or guests see something
- a sensor trips
- a fake identity gets checked
- a drone sends a warning
- doors are forced
- gunfire, explosions, screams
- a hack leaves a trace

Lowering alert

TUG-OF-WAR

Not "I roll against alert" but a deed in the world:

- convince a guard it was harmless (Influence)
- replace camera feeds with old footage (Interface)
- disguise a sensor as a fault (Engineer)
- intercept a drone before it reports (Fight, Stalk)
- stage a party incident (Command, Consort)

On success, alert drops by effect or a rise is prevented.

Interface & Matrix

- Anyone can try simple things with networked tech using Interface. Real hacking (finding hidden devices, exploiting vulnerabilities) needs a cyberdeck.
- Hacks don't get harder automatically. Riskier only once a countermeasure runs, a trace has started or a system was isolated.
- Offline things can only be hacked by cable at the hidden data port, or by hand: Engineer, Finesse, Wreck.

Kessel's tools

HACKER

- **Search Protocol:** you are aware of all online devices nearby; +1d to gather information about high tech.
- **Scratch-built cyberdeck** (smart: can't be hacked against you).
- **Warez:** Armor, Arsenal and Mask need VR. Breach opens a gap at once but alerts the system. Several warez in one run draw attention.
- **Blueprints:** say during the run which plans you loaded.

Zephyr's tools

RIGGER

- **Ace:** start, fly and land any vehicle with Finesse; potency on difficult manoeuvres.
- **Dragonfly:** rotor drone with camera and mic, fits the drone shaft.
- **Utility harness:** incl. Vehicular Override, thermite, hyperglue.

Ways into the tower

ROUTE	STRENGTH · PROBLEM
Glass lift	elegant, close to Venn · gear stands out, lift logs arrivals
Freight lift	tools plausible, close to the keycard · rosters, wrong area
Roof	lots of gear · wind, visible, glass roof
Façade gondola	bypasses the entrance · logged, visible from inside

The job

- Steal the **black briefcase** from the vault.
- It is handed over **unopened**.
- Take **nothing else** from the vault.
- The vault needs the **vault keycard** and **Dr. Venn's eye scan**.
- Pay: **6 nuyen** for the crew.